

Traceable Consent Interface Audit and Versioning

A workflow for scoring layered consent interfaces and tracking how privacy-interface evidence changes over time.

Current evidence package: pilot/method evidence, not a final 20-site dataset.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Consent interfaces are layered design and communication systems. They can make privacy choices visible or hidden, easy or difficult, stable or volatile over time.

Choice pathway
Are Accept, Reject, Customize, and Dismiss available?

Choice effort
How much interaction is needed to reach each path?

Choice framing
Does the text support transparent, unbiased choice?

EVIDENCE PIPELINE

1	Capture	Screenshot, text, DOM ref/hash
2	Attempt	Accept / Reject / Customize / Dismiss
3	Score	Three deterministic layers
4	Version	AuditReport + WeeklySummary

One capture bundle supports both RQ1 scoring and RQ2 longitudinal versioning.

SCORING GUARDRAIL

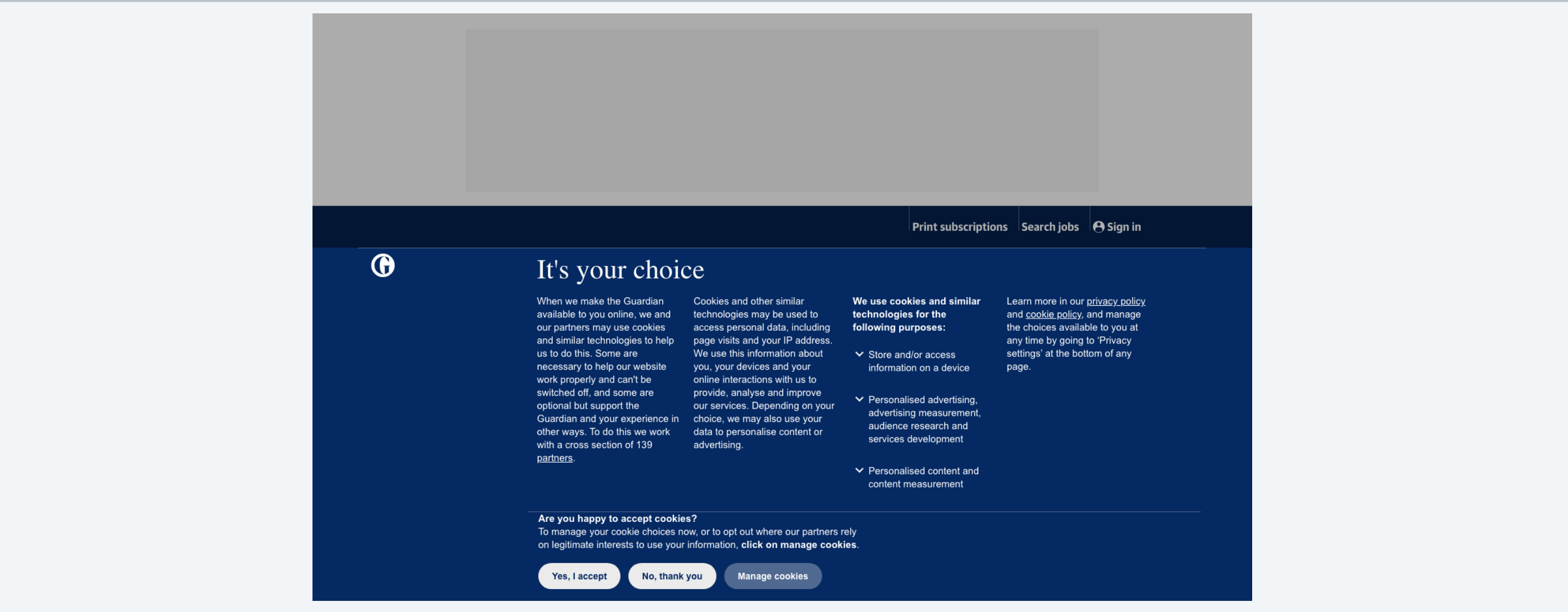
Current pilot scoring uses deterministic DOM and text rules. External models are not wired into scoring; future model output must be schema-validated and evidence-linked.

CURRENT EVIDENCE SNAPSHOT

Week 2 target sites	5
Audit reports	42
Longitudinal summaries	20
Site layer1.png screenshots	326
Synced raw layer1.html files	0
Current-five blank decisions	7
Pending CMP confirmations	8

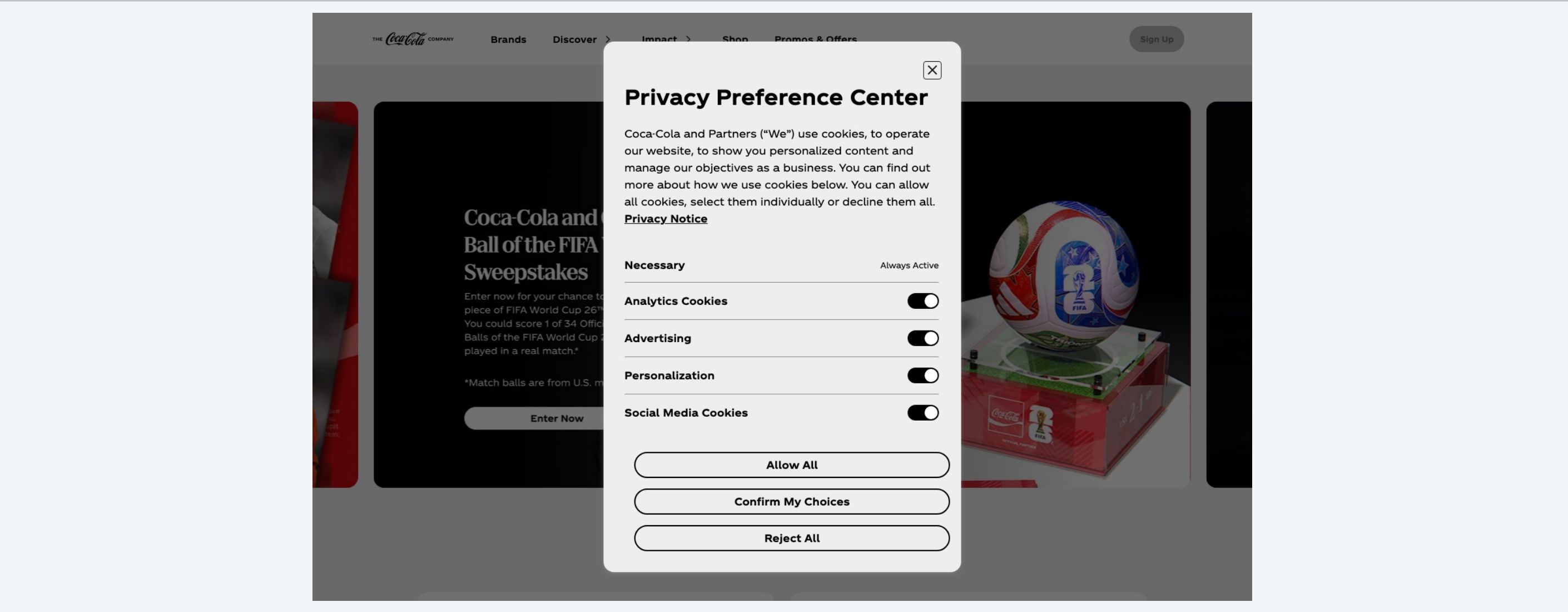
Counts from the current evidence package, rechecked July 25, 2026.

EVIDENCE CARD: THE GUARDIAN



Stored screenshot evidence shows a visible consent-choice screen with accept, reject, and manage-cookie choices. Method evidence only; not a legal-compliance claim.

EVIDENCE CARD: COCA-COLA



Stored screenshot evidence shows a visible Privacy Preference Center with consent controls. Method evidence only; not a legal-compliance claim.

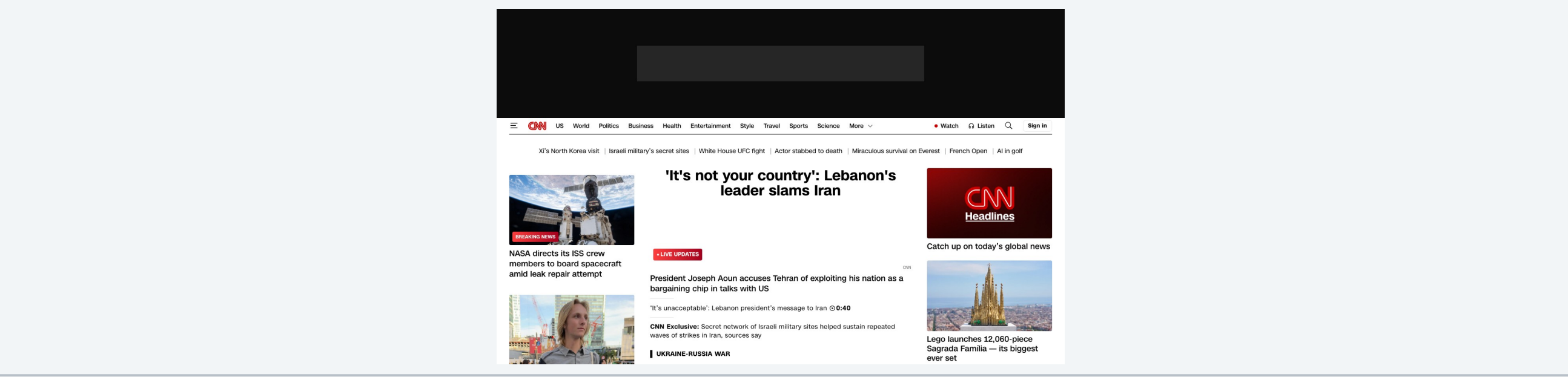
RQ1
How can full consent pathways be scored for unbiased choice?

RQ2
How can consent interfaces be captured and versioned over time?

CONTRAST CASES

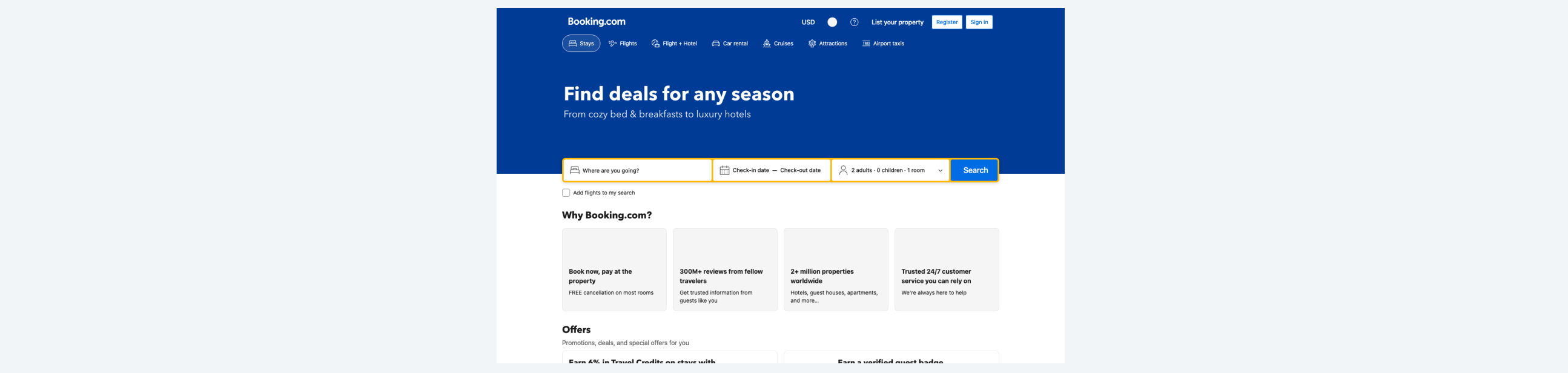
No visible first-screen cookie banner in these stored screenshots.

CNN



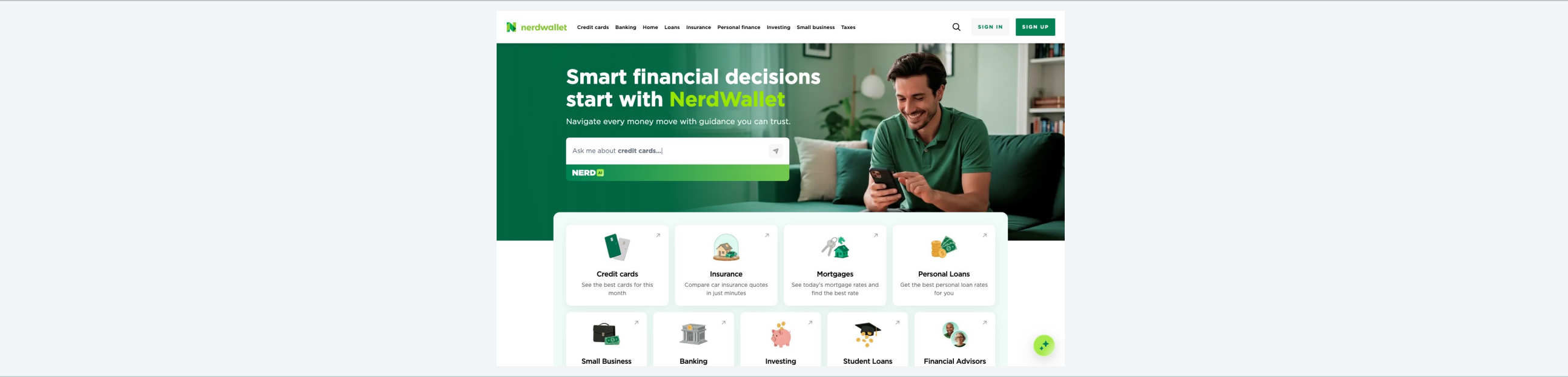
No visible first-screen cookie banner in stored screenshot.

Booking.com



No visible first-screen cookie banner in stored screenshot.

NerdWallet



No visible first-screen cookie banner in stored screenshot.

Important: no-visible-banner contrast cases are not banner-path failures. A separate table label or advisor decision is needed before any final scoring claim.

LIMITATIONS AND NEXT DECISIONS

Pilot/method evidence only. Raw layer1.html files are not synced; 7 current-five decisions are blank; 8 CMP/manual-review confirmations are pending.

Next: confirm pilot framing, validate the two main cards, choose a label for contrast cases, and resolve or explicitly carry the remaining review decisions.

Contribution: a traceable audit-and-versioning workflow for consent-interface evidence. Deep, evidence-linked pilot cases are safer than broad unsupported claims.